

Phone: (701) 801-1220	Access Code:	PIN: 2006#
Lead Facilitator mute all: *51	Lead Facilitator unmute all: *53	Members mute/unmute: *6

Facilitator Guide

KF Introductory Meeting

Facilitator:

- Call in using the PIN code: *2006#
- Arrive ten minutes before the hour to catch the early birds.
- Help the early birds use their **NHG Syllabus and Overview** and, if time permits, ask the first two students if they would read introductions. **Name #1** will read the introductions to KF Circulation, Guidelines, and Mindfulness. **Name #2** will read the introductions to Sharing, Bible, and Integration. Explain where they can find the introductions on their schedule.
- Notice the dings as people join to get a sense of the group size. More than 12 people will be a large group and you'll want to use the large group instructions for Presenting.
- On the hour, start the recording by pressing *9.

Facilitator greets the group: "Welcome, everyone! This is the KF Introductory Meeting for the [year] training cycle. Today's date is _____."

Facilitator reads the following:

Karis is an invitation to a relationship based on mutual generosity.

This is our KF prayer: "Search me, O God, and know my heart. Examine me and know my thoughts. See if there is any way in me that causes pain, and lead me in the ways of eternity." (Psalm 139:23–24)

0:01 OPENING

We have a single purpose at Karis Fellowships: to support one another as we reorient to God and to our true glory. We are Christians who recognize our misorientation, that we have exchanged the truth for the lie of our Idol Self and pursued pride rather than love. We believe that only from our True Self, the self that God created, can we love authentically and become the people God created us to be. We learn to respond to the gift of our real salvation in Jesus Christ by offering our true life to God as a gift, which is holy and acceptable to Him. Every week we come together to ground ourselves in reality, to help us put to death our false strivings and learn to apply real effort to our real growth as we pursue God's will and our true glory.

When we use the term *orientation* in Karis Fellowships, we are talking about realigning with our Creator and living within the realities of our created design. If you are in this group, you have probably been able to admit to yourself that you have deviated from the Creator and from your created design through neurosis. Sometimes the word *neurosis* is a little confusing for our generation, so in KF we use the term *misorientation* instead. Misorientation is a kind of rebellion against our Creator and our design. We have misoriented away from our true purpose and calling by trying to save the life of our idealized self. Our goal is to reorient back to God as His creatures, to learn what is pleasing to Him, and to fulfill our created purpose in this material world, which is to be in relationship with Him.

0:03 PRESENTING

We introduce ourselves to the group as we are at this moment. We respect the group by always announcing our presence.

In Karis Fellowships, we encourage anonymity. There is no need to share your last name, and you can even make up a name to maintain your privacy. Only you know your privacy needs, and we want to protect them as much as we wish to protect our own. Similarly, we protect those close to us by referring to them as *another KF member*, *someone I love*, or *someone who is close to me*. Referring to others in this way helps protect everyone's privacy, and it avoids the appearance of inside knowledge or cliques. It also reminds us that in the group we each tell our own story and not the story of another. Our story is ours and ours alone.

Small group: "When you present, would you please share your first name and where you are calling from, and tell us how you are doing today. Also, let me know if you are sharing a line with another person and if you cannot read. I will begin."

My name is _____, and I am calling from _____. Here is how I am today: _____.

Large group: "When you present, would you each please share your first name and your call location. Also, let me know if you are sharing a line with another person and if you cannot read. I will begin."

My name is _____, and I am calling from _____.

Instructions for Facilitators during Presenting

- List the names of students and members as they present. Make a note of those who are sharing a line or cannot read and, also, of any veteran KF members present.
- If introductions have not already been assigned, choose three people to read.
Name #1 – KF Circulation, Guidelines, Mindfulness
Name #2 – Sharing, Bible, and Integration
Name #3 (an experienced KF member) – KC Confessions, Toolbox
- If not previously determined, assign readings to KF Readers: Mindfulness teaching, Toolbox, Sharing, Bible Teaching, and Integration.
- If you wish, use the table below to record reading assignments.

KARIS CIRCULATION	Intro #1:	
GUIDELINES & LIMITATIONS	Intro #1:	
MINDFULNESS & MEDITATION	Intro #1:	Lesson:
KARIS CONFESSIONS & TOOLBOX	Intro #3:	Lesson:
SHARING	Intro #2:	Lesson:
BIBLE TEACHING	Intro #2:	Lesson:
INTEGRATION	Intro #2:	Lesson:

- Prepare for the Sharing time by dividing the names into break-out rooms. To help the meeting stay on time, assign only 3–4 people to each group. If possible, put an experienced KF member in each group. SL means “sharing a line”.

GROUP 1	SL	GROUP 2	SL	GROUP 3	SL	GROUP 4	SL
GROUP 5	SL	GROUP 6	SL	GROUP 7	SL	GROUP 8	SL

Facilitator: “I will read a little explanation after some of the introductions. I will always let you know when to proceed to the next section. All right, **Name #1**, please go ahead and read the Introduction to Karis Circulation.”

0:09 KARIS CIRCULATION

Name #1 reads the Introduction to KARIS CIRCULATION

We practice mutual generosity with Karis Fellowships by returning gifts of service, skill, and finances. Through volunteering and a monthly gift of \$10 or more, we support and protect KF training for ourselves and for others. As we receive, we give. To participate, visit Give a Gift on the website.

Facilitator reads:

Karis Fellowships is an organization run completely by volunteers, but our website and the other services that we use require financial support. If you receive gifts of training from Karis Fellowships that enhance your well-being and your connection to God, return regular financial gifts to the Fellowships. By doing so, you invite more well-being and connection into your life. Your gifts say, “Thank you.” In KF, we refer to this principle as *circulation*. It is the essence of karis.

0:11 GUIDELINES & LIMITATIONS

Facilitator: “**Name #1**, let’s go on to GUIDELINES & LIMITATIONS.”

Name #1 reads the Introduction to GUIDELINES AND LIMITATIONS.

We cooperate for the security and efficiency of the group.

We adhere to the time restraints.

We present ourselves authentically.

We offer our story and allow others to tell theirs.

We hold in sacred confidence what we learn about each other.

We withhold opinions on outside issues while in the meeting.

We commit to the authority of the Bible for our beliefs and choices.

We practice what we learn.

We share our finances, as we are able, to support the group.

We pray for each other.

Facilitator reads:

Since we are committed to adhering to time restraints, we will always begin our meetings on time and end on time, or before. If, however, from time to time, you need to join the group late, please call in anyway. Although the call-in prompt asks you to immediately announce your presence, wait until the facilitator acknowledges you. If the facilitator forgets, go ahead and announce yourself when there is a pause in the meeting. If you should join the meeting and find yourself in the middle of silence, it is probably because the group is in mindfulness training. Just be patient and wait a minute for someone to start speaking again. You will know that the group is meeting because the call-in prompt will tell you how many people are gathered on the call.

0:13 MINDFULNESS & MEDITATION TRAINING

Facilitator: “Name #1, let’s go on to MINDFULNESS TRAINING please.”

Name #1 reads the Introduction.

We seek mindful living and true connection with God. Mindfulness teaches us gentle moment-by-moment awareness as we go about our lives. Meditation trains our mind, body, will, and heart for connection. With daily practice and patient endurance, we learn how to focus, to find stillness, to quiet the chatter and demands of our Idol Self. We practice the presence of God by dwelling, unguarded, in the present moment with the gift of our True Self.

Mindfulness Reader: “Thank you, Name #1.” *(If the group is running behind, shave 10 seconds off the pauses. You will also be able to make up time during the Sharing)*

Karis Fellowships is more than an education. Over the years, we have seen that regular attendance will actually start to orient members and set them on a path toward real glory. One of our tools for orientation is the practice of mindfulness and Christian meditation. Although the words *meditation* and *mindfulness* are often used interchangeably, the practice of each has a distinct purpose. In KF, mindfulness training simply means that we train our minds and bodies to notice, without judgment, what is happening inside and around us in the moment. We define meditation as training ourselves to quiet our minds and connect with God beyond words or images. We learn to dwell alone with Him in silence and stillness. Christians have been meditating for centuries, but we have largely lost the tradition of meditation in the Protestant church.

Mindfulness and meditation are difficult for everyone. That’s why they are called spiritual disciplines. Disciples are learners, and a discipline is something that you have to learn. It takes time to learn any new skill, and Karis Fellowships supports you in the process of learning. Think of your mind as a new puppy learning to sit still on command. Everything distracts the puppy at first; a puppy can only focus on a command for a few seconds. The trainer knows that. He doesn’t punish the puppy for not doing what it is

not yet trained to do. Instead, he rewards the puppy for what it tries to do. Pat yourself on the head every time you make an effort to practice these new skills. Your lasting reward will be added control over your mind and emotions, which will lead to more peace, strength, and stability in your life.

You can find the mindfulness and meditation scripts from these meetings on the KF website.

Let's begin learning the **3-Minute Breathing Space**.¹ Follow these basic instructions as I guide you.

We start with **AWARENESS**.

Bring yourself into the present moment by adopting an appropriate posture. Sit upright, if you can, and straighten your neck. Lower your chin a little, and let your shoulders fall back naturally. Think of the crown of your head reaching toward the heavens and your tailbone reaching toward the earth. Plant the entire sole of each foot on the ground or sit cross-legged on the floor. If possible, close your eyes. *(Pause)* Now ask yourself: *What is my experience right now—in thoughts, in feelings, and in my physical sensations?* *(Repeat)* *(Pause)* Get to know yourself a little. As you breathe, acknowledge and register your experience, even if it is unwanted or uncomfortable. Notice the thoughts within your mind, your feelings, and what your body is sensing. Breathe, and simply observe for thirty seconds. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Move to **GATHERING**.

Gently direct your full attention to your breathing—to each in-breath and each out-breath as they follow one after the other. Your breath can function as an anchor to bring you into the present moment, to help you focus your awareness, and to guide you into stillness. Observe your breathing for thirty seconds. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

And now we will move to **EXPANDING**.

Expand the field of your awareness around your breathing so that you sense your body as a whole. Notice how your body moves with the breathing. Notice your posture. What is your face doing? Observe and breathe for thirty seconds. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Pause, and gently redirect your mind back to the meeting.

The **3-Minute Breathing Space** provides a way to step out of the habitual reactions of automatic pilot mode. When events occur, a breathing space can help you thoughtfully reconnect with yourself and with God. Maintaining awareness in the moment, without making judgments, is the key skill to learn through this practice.

Begin your own daily practice this week, spending one minute on each of the three steps. Try following the instructions for the **3-Minute Breathing Space** in the morning and then again later in the day. This will help you learn to be aware of what you are experiencing in the present moment—right here, right now. You can practice this mindfulness exercise using the teaching notes to guide you, or you can download the instructions under the **Toolbox** menu on the KF website. Alternatively, you can call this meeting's playback number and follow along with the group again.

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about this training?")

*(If there is time, the **Facilitator** can offer the discussion questions below)*

- What has been your experience with mindfulness practice or meditation? What is your present understanding?
- Would any experienced member like to share what the **3-Minute Breathing Space** has done for them?

0:22 KARIS CONFESSION

Facilitator: “Let’s move to the Karis Confession.”

Facilitator reads:

At each meeting, we listen to the KF Confessions to remind ourselves of what we learned in the *Neurosis and Human Growth* book study and, also, to take us beyond the study into the promise and vision that God has for each of us. There are twelve Confessions because there are twelve months. Each month we look in detail at one of the Karis Confessions.

Facilitator: “Name #3 would you now read the Introduction to the KARIS CONFESSION and the Confessions.”

Name #3 reads the KF CONFESSION and then goes straight into the TOOLBOX Introduction.

We remind each other of the path that leads to our healing. In James 5:16–17 we read, “Therefore, confess your misorientation to one another, and pray for one another so that you may be healed. The energetic and active petition of an oriented person has much power.” The Karis Confessions help us confess our sin and affirm our glory.

1. **We confess** that we have worshiped and served an Idol Self that we have created.
2. **We abandoned** the glory that was ours, designed for us by our Creator.
3. **We constructed** legal systems based on our own assessment of good and evil.
4. **We judged** ourselves and others with contempt and felt justified in our wrath.
5. **We attacked** and cruelly suppressed our True Self and lost our true life.
6. **We chose** to foster illusions to save the life of our Idol Self.
7. **We commit** now to live in reality, choosing to believe rather than judge.
8. **We co-labor** with the Creator to seek and to save that which was lost.
9. **We learn** to withdraw from the Idol Self and begin investing in our True Self.
10. **We honor** our limitations and seek lives of gratitude.
11. **We take** responsibility for any damage that we have done.
12. **We circulate** our true resources, reconnecting to our Creator and to the Creation.

0:24 TOOLBOX

Name #3 continues with the TOOLBOX Introduction.

We offer tools that help us cooperate with God in the development of our True Self.

Toolbox Reader:

This week we will explore how Karis Fellowships works. Let’s begin with how the meetings are structured.

Each meeting is divided into the same sequence of introductions and training. Bring a copy of the **Meeting Schedule** with you to the meeting so that you can help by reading one of the introductions. During the **Toolbox** segment of the meeting, we explore integration techniques, worksheets, and practical training

exercises that help us process our anxieties, conflicts, and self-hate in very practical ways. We learn to interrupt the autopilot of our neurotic solution, which drives our chronic reactions, and we train ourselves to use that same energy to make healthy choices, building the glorious life God intends for each of us.

Let's now look at five points that describe our work in Karis Fellowships.

1. **The *real self* is the *True Self***

In the book study, we learned that our present solution for anxiety and conflicts is neurotic, or misoriented. In Karis Fellowships, we believe that the *real self* that Dr. Horney talks about is the *True Self*, which God created.² We use the term True Self because this self is congruent with the truth. We know that God is true and that Jesus is the Way, the Truth, and the Life.³ As we follow the way of Jesus, we grow into our True Self, and we become the truth of who He created us to be. We learn to build a life that declares the glory of God.

2. **The *idealized self* is the *Idol Self***

In the Fellowships, we call the *idealized self* the *Idol*—I-D-O-L—or *Idol Self*. Someday you might want to go through the Bible looking at the characteristics of idols, graven images, and false gods. You may find it striking, as Nancy did, to see the similarity between the characteristics of the idealized self and an idol. To dismantle this Idol, we must commit to the goal of learning real love.

3. **Karis Fellowships is a training program**

During the year of training, you will be introduced to many tools that will help restore your True Self. The training will feel overwhelming. Depending on your neurotic development, you will want to master it all immediately, feel chronic self-judgment, or feel rebellious and do as little as possible. Remember that you are like a puppy and can only learn at your own pace. You learn by taking small puppy steps toward developing endurance and self-management, which prepares you to take up more training in the future. You can't learn it all or know it all at once, and that's why many KF members continue to train with KF for several years.

4. **Showing up**

Members of Karis Fellowships have reported that just showing up for the meetings each week has changed their lives. We would encourage you to use whichever KF tools you can during the week, but if you are an overly busy puppy or a puppy that feels frozen and overwhelmed, your first step will be to simply attend the meetings. If you miss a meeting, you can join other meetings during the week or listen to your regular meeting through the playback number provided on the KF website. Scripts and contact numbers for other meetings are also provided on the website.

5. **Take your work seriously**

It is God's desire that you learn to love. As you learn to love, God's love is able to flow through you to your family, to your community, and to this messed-up world—you can learn to stop being part of the mess. By restoring your True Self, you allow God's will of love to be done through you, on earth as it is in heaven.⁴

Our prayer might go something like this:

God, my Father and Creator, I choose to begin this journey of love with You. (Repeat)

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, “Does anyone have comments or questions about the Toolbox?”)

(If there is time, the **Facilitator** can offer the discussion questions below)

- What one or two words would you use to describe how you feel right now?
- When you consider the training of a puppy, what comes to mind?

0:30 SHARING

Facilitator: “Thank you all for sharing. Let’s move to the SHARING lesson.”

Sharing Reader:

Before we start the sharing segment of the meeting, you might wish to have some purified drinking water available. Water helps our bodies process our experience during the meetings.

Let’s talk about the **Meeting Preparation Guide** for a moment. Some members have a ring binder in which they store completed and blank preparation guides, KF documents, and worksheets. With a completed preparation guide, you are ready to efficiently offer your story in the meeting, and you also have a record of your own restoration. Alternatively, you can download the guides and keep a record of your recovery and progress on your computer. The DOC version will allow you to modify your document.

In the **Meeting Preparation Guide**, we use the terms *oriented* and *misoriented*. To keep things simple, Nancy has reduced lots of Greek words down to those two basic concepts. Essentially, these Greek words express the idea of living in harmony and correspondence with God and His Creation, or not. When we are oriented, we make choices that are in harmony with God’s desires and promises. Orientation is the work of the True Self. Oriented people are supported by God and connected to His resources, and they consistently produce the Fruit of the Spirit.⁵ By living their lives God’s way, they contribute to the Creation and to the community. The Greek words that Nancy has summarized as *orientation* are often translated in our Bibles as *righteousness, justice, love, faith, walking by the Spirit, and goodness*.

When we are misoriented, we are out of harmony with God, ourselves, and the Creation, and we actively create harm, often without realizing it. Misorientation through pride is the work of the Idol Self, and God will always oppose our pride. As a result, we sense deep down that we are neither supported by God nor connected to His resources. When we lack this support and connection, we cannot consistently produce the Fruit of the Spirit in our lives—we are neurotic. The Greek words that Nancy has bundled into the term *misorientation* are translated in our Bibles as *sin, transgression, unrighteousness, the flesh, disobedience*, etc. Basically, these words mean missing the mark, wandering from the path, stumbling, error or delusion, and failure.

The other items in the **Meeting Preparation Guide** are self-explanatory. However, thankfulness, which is at the end of the guide, is very important in the process of reorientation and is well worth highlighting here. We will see in the KF Romans study that misoriented people do not honor God, nor do they give thanks. Gratitude reminds us that we are not God. It also helps us be aware of how God is supporting us, even when our feelings are telling us a tale of woe. Gratitude is physically and spiritually beneficial. Learning to be thankful in all things is part of the reorientation process.

If you are new to the group, feel free just to listen during the sharing time. When you are ready, it is to your advantage, and it also benefits the group, if you give the gift of sharing your experience while you

train. If you wish to share, we encourage you to set a timer to remind you of the 5-minute time limitation. This is simply an opportunity to share your own work. We do not give counsel; neither do we ask for advice. When a member has finished sharing, we simply say “Thank you” to acknowledge his or her contribution.

Let’s begin our sharing.

Facilitator: “Name #2, would you read the Introduction to SHARING?”

Name #2 reads the Introduction to SHARING.

We give our True Self a voice by confessing our progress and discoveries. We learn to stop judging our expression which defuses the Idol’s compelling need to perform. We also practice the gift of listening to another’s voice without judgment or reaction. We listen with compassion and appreciation for the effort another has made toward orientation. Real sharing reminds us that we are not alone in our struggle toward an authentic life.

Please use your Meeting Preparation Guide to share your story for up to five minutes.

Facilitator assigns groups from a prepared list. “To get to your room, press *3 and then at the prompt, press your room number. You might use a timer to help you limit your sharing to 5-minutes. Return to the main group in 30 minutes, or before, by pressing *3*.”

Facilitator: “Welcome back everyone.”

*(If there is time, the **Facilitator** can ask the discussion questions below)*

- Does anyone have questions about the sharing time or the **Meeting Preparation Guide**?
- What motivated you to explore NHG and KF?
- Would any KF volunteers like to share why they serve in KF?
- What do you think was God’s purpose in creating human beings?
- Why are you thinking about joining KF now? What brought you to this place?

1:00 BIBLE TEACHING

Facilitator: “Name #2, start us off with the Introduction to BIBLE TEACHING.”

Name #2 reads the BIBLE TEACHING Introduction.

We affirm the Bible as our one authority for our beliefs and choices. A mature guide can help us understand what the Bible teaches about our true nature and glory. We also learn the Scriptural basis for the tools offered in Karis Fellowships. With increasing vision, we develop our endurance, courage, and skills to live in the truth of who we were created to be.

Bible Teaching Reader:

We encourage you to read your Bible throughout the week and look for examples of what you are learning in KF. If you have your Bible with you now, turn to the Gospel of John, chapter 17. The whole of this chapter is our text for the introductory lesson. Here, Jesus is praying for His followers. His prayer is an astounding revelation of the true glory that He has in mind for us. Before we look at the nature of this true glory, let’s review what we learned in the book study about our self-manufactured glory.

We learned that we have a neurotic need to search for personal glory. Our backgrounds, our conflicts about other people, our deep anxiety, our natural strengths and weaknesses, and our need for self-confidence all pressed us into seeking an imagined safe place. We then tried to make that safe place our identity—we created an Idol Self. That Idol Self can never feel safe because it is false. It is a house built on sand, but it gives us an illusion of glory.⁶ The Idol uses our powerful imagination to validate this false glory by exaggerating evidence that perpetuates our illusions and by dismissing any evidence that might call us back to reality. Chronic insecurity regarding our real attributes presses us beyond what is rational into an imagined identity characterized by superior attributes and abilities.

In our Bible passage, however, we discover that we are designed by God to grow into the true glory that He intended for us. Consequently, deep within, we are seeking the natural fulfillment of our original design. We were created to be glorious, and through revealing our glory as God's creatures, we declare God's glory in our own unique way. This brings us to the big question: What is glory?

In John 17, Jesus prays to His Father about Himself and about us, His followers. Let's consider some of the aspects of Biblical glory that this intimate prayer reveals.

1. Glory is of primary importance

Jesus talks to the Father about glory right from the start. He wants His Father to glorify Him so that He can glorify His Father. The ultimate purpose of our true glory is to enhance God's reputation.

2. Glory has to do with giving

In verses 2 and 4, we see between the Father and the Son a dynamic relationship of giving, which overflows to us in the gift of eternal life. Jesus tells the Father, "I have brought glory to You, Father, by fulfilling the work that You gave me to do."⁷ The Father gave Jesus authority and, also, a glorious mission, and by fulfilling that mission, Jesus returned a gift that glorified His Father. This almost incomprehensible generosity between the Father and the Son is a demonstration of glory, and we are invited to participate in this glorious relationship of mutual giving that overflows into the lives of others.

3. Glory is revealed through joyful lives

Jesus prays that His disciples will be filled with His joy. His joy in us is an expression of His glory.

4. Glory is doing things God's way

In verse 14 we learn that, along with His glory, Jesus has given God's word to His followers. This is the *logos*. We can translate this Greek word as *God's way of doing things*. Jesus is our only example of a human being who has accomplished the mission God designed for him while remaining fully integrated with his True Self. Jesus gave us the great gift of showing us how to fulfill our own glory by doing things God's way. The natural result of our glory is that others can watch us and learn something about God.

5. Glory offers the potential for unity

With regard to our KF work, the particular aspect of this glory that Nancy would like you to notice is in verse 22. Jesus affirms, "I have given to them the very same glory that You gave to Me so that they may be one just as We are one." God gave Jesus glory, and Jesus has passed that same glory on to us. He has done this for the sake of unity, not primarily with each other but with Him and within ourselves. In Jesus, we are no longer a kingdom divided against itself, fighting to suppress the True Self and actualize the Idol Self; we are no longer at war with ourselves and at war with God.⁸ Now, because of

the work of Jesus Christ, we can stand unified. It is only in being unified, just as He is, that we can act with consistent power, love, and confidence in this world.

Consider revisiting this chapter and see if you can make more connections between giving, glory, unity, and love.

We might pray this very bold prayer together:

Lord Jesus, glorify me so that I might glorify You. (Repeat)

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, “Does anyone have comments or questions about the Bible teaching?”)

*(If there is time, the **Facilitator** can ask the discussion questions below)*

- What is your understanding of glory?
- What was new or interesting to you in this teaching?
- How do you feel about God glorifying you?

1:10 INTEGRATION

Facilitator: “Name #2, let’s go ahead with the INTEGRATION Introduction.”

Name #2 reads the INTEGRATION Introduction.

We integrate what we have learned into the rest of our person. The meeting starts us down a path to our healing, and sometimes we feel an emotional or physical response to what we have learned. We take this time to reorient ourselves on a physical and emotional level.

Integration Reader:

Bring some purified water to the meetings. Water helps your body process what it is experiencing. You may also wish to take some notes on the back of your **Meeting Preparation Guide**, or you might start a KF journal. Assume an alert and upright posture, whatever works for you, and breathe. *(Pause for 10 seconds)*

The FAITH Process

We always end our meetings with the **FAITH Process**. F-A-I-T-H is an acronym for Feelings, Awareness, Inquiry, Talk to Jesus, and Heal.

Here is our integration focus: *Consider God’s generous gifts. (Repeat) (Pause for 30 seconds)*

F is for Feelings

As you *consider God’s generous gifts*, how does it feel? *(Pause)* Your feelings are yours to teach you about yourself, to guide you, and to train you. They can often be uncomfortable. *(Pause)* You can learn to recognize and honor your feelings without allowing them to master you. Recognize with compassion whatever you are experiencing, and breathe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

A is for Awareness without judgment

As you breathe and *consider God's generous gifts*, allow whatever you are experiencing to rest in your awareness. You might notice a compulsion to push thoughts or feelings away, to judge them, or to justify them. We often flush our feelings and thoughts from our awareness before they have a chance to teach us. *(Pause)* Feelings and passing thoughts are not right or wrong; they just are. Give yourself permission now to explore them without judgment, and breathe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

I is for Inquiry: What is my body saying?

Breathe, and bring your attention to your body. Notice what it is doing when you *consider God's generous gifts*. What sensations are there? *(Pause)* Your body is always talking to you. You may not understand its language right now, but you can observe. Perhaps you will find unfairness or resentment in your body; perhaps hope or joy. Just explore. *(Pause)* If your sensations are uncomfortable, you can move your attention to an area of your body that is not reacting, and rest. When you are ready, return to observe those uncomfortable sensations. Breathe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

T is for Talk to Jesus

You might imagine that you are leaning back in the safe and loving arms of Jesus as together you *consider God's generous gifts*. Do you feel comfortable, uncomfortable, or are you shutting down? Just observe. *(Pause)* When you consider God's gifts, what story do you want to tell? *(Pause)* Are you afraid of something? Do you hope for something? Observe your responses as just information, and breathe with a long exhaling breath, like a sigh. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

H is for Heal

For thousands of years, human beings have had very strong feelings when they have *considered God's generous gifts*. You also are a human creature, and you are not alone in your feelings. *(Pause)* You can breathe rather than reacting and getting caught up in explanations. Breathe with compassion for our human condition, and help your body release with a long exhaling breath. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Pause. Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about the integration?")

*(If there is time, the **Facilitator** can ask the discussion questions below)*

- What was your experience with the **FAITH Process**?
- For veteran KF members, have your reactions to this integration focus changed since you've been in training? How have they changed?
- When you heard the integration focus, what was your reaction?
- If you've done this integration before, have you noticed any changes in your experience?

1:28 ENDING PRAYER

Facilitator: "Let's go to our ENDING PRAYER."

Dear Father and Creator,

Thank you for this time together. Hold us in the power of this new understanding as You guide us to our glory and to the truth. Lead us to the next step in our healing this week as we co-labor with You to reorient our lives for a more effective flow and to flourish in our connection with our True Self, with the Creation, and with You, for the glory and honor of our Lord Jesus. Amen.

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, the **Facilitator** asks, “Does anyone have comments or questions about this meeting, or would anyone like to share their experience of the meeting?”)

1:29 ANNOUNCEMENTS

Facilitator: “Great work, everybody. We just have one announcement.”

If you have completed the prerequisites for joining KF and wish to begin training in the next cycle, please register on the website under the Registration tab or email admin@karisfellowships.com for assistance. If your membership is approved, the admin team will allow you access to the KF website where you will find the meeting days and times, call-in numbers, and various guides and worksheets. We would like to remind everyone that Karis Fellowships is a gift offered by volunteers and that no one is under any obligation.

Facilitator: “Does anyone have any questions about Karis Fellowships?”

Facilitator: “Goodbye, everyone! Thank you for joining this meeting.”

Note to Facilitator: To turn off the recording, press *9 and then follow the prompt.

¹ Zindel Segal, J. Mark G. Williams and John D Teasdale, *Mindfulness-Based Cognitive Therapy for Depression* (New York: Guilford Press, 2013), 208. Adapted for Karis Fellowships by Nancy Diven.

² Karen Horney, *Neurosis and Human Growth* (New York: Norton, 1991).

³ John 14:6.

⁴ Matt. 6:10.

⁵ Gal. 5:22–23.

⁶ Matt. 7:24–27.

⁷ John 17:4.

⁸ Matt. 12:25.